# INTAKE-ARBITER -- FREE-COOLING DECISION REPORT

Data centres over-cool, continuously, because nobody can promise them the hours ahead. A chiller plant needs hours of notice to change mode, and a thermometer only ever reports NOW -- so the mechanical chillers keep running through hours that outside air could have cooled for free. FortyGuard closes that gap with heat intelligence 2 m above the ground, the height a ground-mounted condenser actually breathes. This agent turns that forecast into an hour-by-hour schedule carrying a calibrated safety bound.

## THE SITE

| | |
|---|---|
| Location | Vantage Santa Clara CA2, CA -- station KSJC, America/Los_Angeles |
| Committed pair | OSM 1314010354 -> 1075445245<br>Vantage Santa Clara CA2 / OSM way 1075445245 |
| Facade gap | 350.5 m between the two halls |
| Weather record | 43,747 real hourly records from KSJC |
| Plume physics | 576 steady-state solves on this site's own footprints; worst intake rise 0.2056 C at 305 deg |

FortyGuard data: weather and geometry are this site's own; the four measured FortyGuard level offsets and the N-26 coverage record are Ashburn's, because only Ashburn has forecast/outcome day pairs. Quote the hours for this site; quote the coverage for Ashburn.

## THIS REPORT IS A SNAPSHOT, NOT THE LIVE PAGE

The interface recomputes the decision for whatever configuration a reader selects. This file was generated at build time for the ONE configuration named below, chosen because it is the configuration in which this site's agent does the most while still changing mode at least once. If the numbers on screen differ from the numbers here, the configuration differs -- compare the two lists before concluding anything else.

| | |
|---|---|
| Day | 2021-01-03 (clear_cool) |
| Plant limit | 18.0 C |
| Notice required | 6 h |
| Forecast skill | 0.00 relative to persistence |
| Level anchor | sensor |
| Condenser bank | longest facade |
| Switch budget | 2 mode changes per day |
| Minimum dwell | 3 h |
| Max dew point | 15.0 C (Green Grid WP#46 p.6) |

## WHAT THE AGENT DID ON THIS DAY

The agent ran free cooling for 6 of 24 hours with 2 mode changes. The reactive incumbent took 10 hours -- 4 more -- but declared 0 unsafe hours against the agent's 0. 10 hours were safe but still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them.

| | |
|---|---|
| Agent | 6 of 24 hours free cooling, 2 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s) |
| Incumbent | 10 of 24 hours free cooling, 2 mode change(s), 0 unsafe hour(s)<br>10 hour(s) passed every gate and still ran chillers, because the schedule could not afford them |

## EVERY HOUR, AND THE REASON FOR IT

| hh | mode | safe | binding | bound | limit | actual | margin |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 00 | mechanical | yes | - | 9.050 | 18.0 | 10.560 | 3.098 |
| 01 | mechanical | yes | - | 9.600 | 18.0 | 10.560 | 2.663 |
| 02 | mechanical | yes | - | 10.160 | 18.0 | 10.560 | 2.525 |
| 03 | mechanical | no | refusal | 10.239 | 18.0 | 10.560 | 2.063 |
| 04 | FREE | yes | - | 10.710 | 18.0 | 10.560 | 2.354 |
| 05 | FREE | yes | - | 10.710 | 18.0 | 10.560 | 2.044 |
| 06 | FREE | yes | - | 11.260 | 18.0 | 10.560 | 2.012 |

| | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 07 | FREE | yes | - | 12.295 | 18.0 | 11.110 | 1.818 |
| 08 | FREE | yes | - | 14.600 | 18.0 | 11.110 | 2.204 |
| 09 | FREE | yes | - | 17.370 | 18.0 | 11.110 | 2.891 |
| 10 | mechanical | no | dry-bulb | 20.150 | 18.0 | 12.220 | 3.656 |
| 11 | mechanical | no | refusal | 22.904 | 18.0 | 13.330 | 4.602 |
| 12 | mechanical | no | refusal | 23.991 | 18.0 | 12.780 | 4.614 |
| 13 | mechanical | no | dry-bulb | 24.590 | 18.0 | 13.890 | 4.779 |
| 14 | mechanical | no | refusal | 22.350 | 18.0 | 13.498 | 3.942 |
| 15 | mechanical | no | refusal | 20.124 | 18.0 | 12.780 | 3.790 |
| 16 | mechanical | yes | - | 17.861 | 18.0 | 12.780 | 3.119 |
| 17 | mechanical | yes | - | 15.700 | 18.0 | 12.220 | 2.719 |
| 18 | mechanical | yes | - | 12.370 | 18.0 | 12.220 | 2.505 |
| 19 | mechanical | no | refusal | 11.761 | 18.0 | 11.670 | 2.880 |
| 20 | mechanical | yes | switch budget | 10.604 | 18.0 | 11.670 | 3.498 |
| 21 | mechanical | yes | switch budget | 9.600 | 18.0 | 10.560 | 3.457 |
| 22 | mechanical | yes | switch budget | 10.093 | 18.0 | 11.110 | 3.568 |
| 23 | mechanical | yes | switch budget | 10.700 | 18.0 | 11.110 | 4.002 |

bound  = the agent's 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air, forecast plus margin
actual = what the intake temperature turned out to be, from the station record
margin = group-conditional forecast error for that hour of day, plus plume spread

## THE REASONING, HOUR BY HOUR

**00:00 MECHANICAL**

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 9.050 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: no relaxation of either the switch budget or the dwell would free it, so the surrounding hours are worth more. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

**01:00 MECHANICAL**

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 9.600 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: no relaxation of either the switch budget or the dwell would free it, so the surrounding hours are worth more. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

**02:00 MECHANICAL**

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 10.160 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: no relaxation of either the switch budget or the dwell would free it, so the surrounding hours are worth more. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

**03:00 MECHANICAL [refusal]**

Mechanical, and the reason is a REFUSAL rather than a temperature. At this wind bearing a building sits between the condensers and the air intake. The dispersion model has no representation of a building standing in the flow, so any number it produced here would be meaningless. The agent declines to certify the hour instead of returning a figure it cannot stand behind.

**04:00 FREE-COOLING**

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 10.710 C, which is 7.290 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 2.354 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 2.204 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.1504 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

**05:00 FREE-COOLING**

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 10.710 C, which is 7.290 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 2.044 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.893 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.1504 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

**06:00  FREE-COOLING**

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 11.260 C, which is 6.740 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 2.012 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.862 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.1504 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

**07:00  FREE-COOLING**

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 12.295 C, which is 5.705 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 1.818 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 1.744 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.0747 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

**08:00  FREE-COOLING**

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 14.600 C, which is 3.400 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 2.204 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 2.054 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.1504 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

**09:00  FREE-COOLING**

Free cooling. The 90 %-nominal upper bound on intake air is 17.370 C, which is 0.630 C under the 18.0 C plant limit. That bound is the forecast plus a margin of 2.891 C, and the margin is measured, not chosen: 2.741 C of group-conditional forecast error for this hour of day, plus 0.1504 C for how much the plume could move if the wind direction is off by the amount FortyGuard's forecast is actually off by.

**10:00  MECHANICAL  [dry-bulb]**

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 20.150 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 2.150 C. It would take a limit 2.150 C higher, or a bound 2.150 C tighter, to change this hour.

**11:00  MECHANICAL  [refusal]**

Mechanical, and the reason is a REFUSAL rather than a temperature. At this wind bearing a building sits between the condensers and the air intake. The dispersion model has no representation of a building standing in the flow, so any number it produced here would be meaningless. The agent declines to certify the hour instead of returning a figure it cannot stand behind.

**12:00  MECHANICAL  [refusal]**

Mechanical, and the reason is a REFUSAL rather than a temperature. At this wind bearing a building sits between the condensers and the air intake. The dispersion model has no representation of a building standing in the flow, so any number it produced here would be meaningless. The agent declines to certify the hour instead of returning a figure it cannot stand behind.

**13:00  MECHANICAL  [dry-bulb]**

Mechanical. The upper bound on intake air is 24.590 C against a 18.0 C limit, so it fails by 6.590 C. It would take a limit 6.590 C higher, or a bound 6.590 C tighter, to change this hour.

**14:00  MECHANICAL  [refusal]**

Mechanical, and the reason is a REFUSAL rather than a temperature. At this wind bearing a building sits between the condensers and the air intake. The dispersion model has no representation of a building standing in the flow, so any number it produced here would be meaningless. The agent declines to certify the hour instead of returning a figure it cannot stand behind.

**15:00  MECHANICAL  [refusal]**

Mechanical, and the reason is a REFUSAL rather than a temperature. At this wind bearing a building sits between the condensers and the air intake. The dispersion model has no representation of a building standing in the flow, so any number it produced here would be meaningless. The agent declines to certify the hour instead of returning a figure it cannot stand behind.

**16:00  MECHANICAL**

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 17.861 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: no relaxation of either the switch budget or the dwell would free it, so the surrounding hours are worth more. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

**17:00  MECHANICAL**

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 15.700 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: no relaxation of either the switch budget or the dwell would free it, so the surrounding hours are worth more. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

**18:00  MECHANICAL**

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 12.370 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: no relaxation of either the switch budget or the dwell would free it, so the surrounding hours are worth more. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

**19:00  MECHANICAL  [refusal]**

Mechanical, and the reason is a REFUSAL rather than a temperature. At this wind bearing a building sits between the condensers and the air intake. The dispersion model has no representation of a building standing in the flow, so any number it produced here would be meaningless. The agent declines to certify the hour instead of returning a figure it cannot stand behind.

**20:00  MECHANICAL  [switch budget]**

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 10.604 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

**21:00  MECHANICAL  [switch budget]**

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 9.600 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

**22:00  MECHANICAL  [switch budget]**

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 10.093 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

**23:00  MECHANICAL  [switch budget]**

Mechanical EVEN THOUGH THIS HOUR IS SAFE. Every gate passes -- the bound is 10.700 C against a 18.0 C limit. The schedule is what forbids it: the switch budget of 2 changes per day is already committed elsewhere. This is the one explanation a thermostat cannot give, because a thermostat has no plan to be constrained by. It is also why the decision is a schedule and not a comparison: spending a mode change here would cost a better one later.

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